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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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If you're tired of pushing a traditional vacuum around and want a smart helper that can sweep, mop, and empty itself, the 2026 robot-vacuum market offers three standout options.

We've dug into the specs, real-world tests, and long-term cost estimates to give you a clear, side-by-side look.

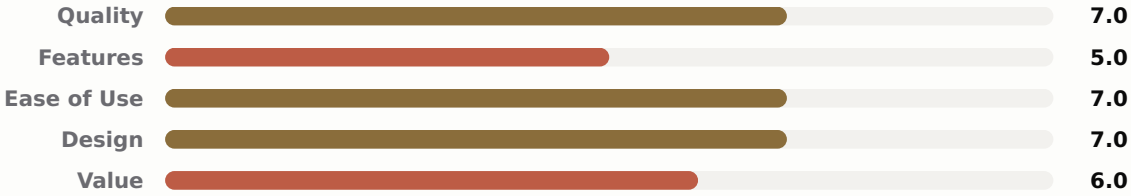
By the end of this guide you'll know which model matches your home, your budget, and your desire for a truly hands-free clean.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Overview: What Sets These Models Apart

The iRobot Roomba 115X line comes in two configurations: one with an AutoEmpty Dock that stores debris for up to 60 days, and a base model that requires manual bin emptying. Both share the same vacuum-mop combo hardware and run on iRobot OS.

The Shark AI Ultra, meanwhile, relies on AI-powered laser navigation and a self-cleaning brushroll but does not include a mopping function or an auto-empty dock.

Pricing & Value (Oct 4 2026)

Model	Price	Original Price	Rating	Ratings Count	Key Features
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	$199.99	$469.99	4.4	5,217	Vacuum-mop combo, self-empty dock, iRobot OS app
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	$319.99	4.4	5,217	Vacuum-mop combo, iRobot OS app, no auto-empty
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	$599.00	4.0	23,990	AI laser navigation, self-cleaning brushroll, XL-capacity dustbin

The dock adds convenience but also a modest price premium, while the Shark Ultra leans into navigation technology at a similar price point.

Cleaning Performance: Suction, Mopping & Floor-Type Suitability

All three models advertise strong suction suitable for carpets, hardwood, and tile. Owners report that the Roomba 115X units lift embedded dirt from low-pile carpet and pick up fine dust on hard floors without scattering debris.

The vibrating mopping pad on the Roomba models adds a light-scrub action that works well on sealed tile, laminate, and finished hardwood, making it possible to tackle kitchen spills or bathroom splashes without pulling out a separate mop.

The Shark AI Ultra focuses on vacuum-only performance; its AI laser navigation maps rooms efficiently and the self-cleaning brushroll reduces hair wrap, but you'll still need a separate mop for wet cleaning.

Navigation, Smart Features & Maintenance

Both Roomba models use iRobot OS, which lets you schedule cleanings, set virtual walls, and view cleaning maps via the app. The AutoEmpty Dock automatically transfers debris to a sealed bag that lasts up to 60 days, reducing hands-on maintenance.

The Shark AI Ultra's AI laser navigation offers precise room mapping and object avoidance, and its self-cleaning brushroll helps keep maintenance low, though the dustbin must be emptied manually after each use.

Long-Term Costs & What You Really Pay

Consider the cost of replacement parts: Roomba AutoEmpty Dock bags run about $15 for a 3-month supply, while the Shark's brushroll and filter replacements are roughly $20 each per year. Over two years, the docked Roomba adds roughly $30 in consumables, whereas the Shark adds about $40.

Which Should You Buy?

If you want the ultimate hands-free experience—vacuum, mop, and self-empty—choose the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock. It delivers the best convenience for a modest price premium.

If you like the vacuum-mop combo but prefer to save upfront and don't mind emptying the bin yourself, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo without the dock gives you the same cleaning power at $139.99.

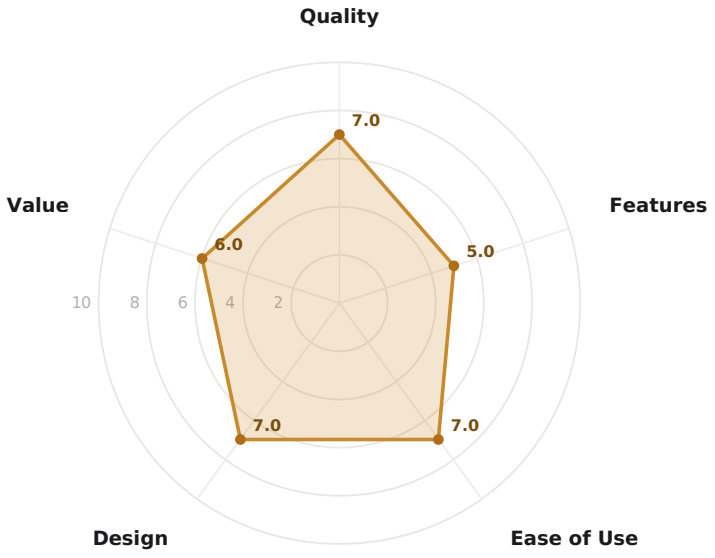
If navigation precision and strong suction are your top priorities and you'll handle mopping separately, the Shark AI Ultra offers laser-guided cleaning at a competitive price.

Pick the model that matches your home's floors, your cleaning habits, and your budget—then enjoy a cleaner house with less effort.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.